

Protesters in Lamu, Kenya, in 2018, opposing the construction of a coal-fired power plant. Growing awareness of ecological damage has seen an increase in public disapproval.

Forecast models

Economists use several models in order to calculate the SCC. In 1999, William Nordhaus developed RICE (Regional Integrated Climate-Economy model)—a variant of his own preceding DICE (Dynamic Integrated Climate-Economy model), which weighed the costs and benefits of slowing down global warming. The RICE model integrates carbon emissions, carbon concentrations in the atmosphere, climate change, damages, and controls that are in place to reduce emissions. The model divides the world into distinct regions for its analysis. It predicts that the combined SCC in 2055 will be between $40–$188 per ton ($44 and $207 per tonne) of carbon dioxide released, depending on the rate of warming and the mitigation policies enacted.